

Minoru Osawa / 大澤 実

🏠 Associate Professor, Institute of Economic Research, Kyoto University
📍 Yoshida-honmachi, Sakyo-ku, Kyoto-shi, Kyoto 606-8501, Japan
🌐 www.minoruosawa.com
✉ osawa@kier.kyoto-u.ac.jp / osawa.minoru@gmail.com

Research Interests

Primary: Urban and Regional Economics.
Secondary: Transportation Science; Evolutionary Game Theory.

Positions

Associate Professor, Institute of Economic Research, Kyoto University	2026.05 – Present
Assistant Professor, Institute of Economic Research, Kyoto University	2020.04 – 2026.04
Assistant Professor, School of Engineering, Tohoku University	2016.10 – 2020.03

Education

Tohoku University	
Ph.D. (Information Sciences)	2016.09
Master of Information Sciences	2014.03
Bachelor of Engineering	2012.03

Research

See [my publication list on researchmap](#) for a complete list of publications, including works in Japanese.

Refereed Publications

1. [Spatial scale of agglomeration and dispersion: Number, spacing, and the spatial extent of cities](#),
Journal of Urban Economics, forthcoming.
(with Takashi Akamatsu, Tomoya Mori, and Yuki Takayama)
2. [Time evolution of city distributions in Germany](#),
Networks and Spatial Economics, 22, 125–151, 2022.
(with Kiyohiro Ikeda and Yuki Takayama)
3. [Perturbed pitchfork bifurcation in a population game: Application to economic geography](#),
Journal of Regional Science, 62(4), 961–980, 2022.
(with Kiyohiro Ikeda, José Maria Gaspar, and Yuki Takayama)
4. [Model-based analysis on social acceptability and feasibility of a focused protection strategy against the COVID-19 pandemic](#),
Scientific Reports, 11, 2003, 2021.
(with Takashi Akamatsu, Takeshi Nagae, Koki Satsukawa, Takara Sakai, Daijiro Mizutani)
5. [Break and sustain bifurcations of \$S_N\$ -invariant equidistant economy](#),
International Journal of Bifurcation and Chaos, 30(16), 2050240, 2020.
(with Kiyohiro Ikeda, José Maria Gaspar, and Hiroki Aizawa)

6. [Equilibrium refinement for a model of non-monocentric internal structures of cities: A potential game approach](#), *Journal of Economic Theory*, 187, 105025, 2020.
(with Takashi Akamatsu)
7. [First-best dynamic assignment of commuters with endogenous heterogeneities in a corridor network](#), *Transportation Research Part B: Methodological*, 117, 811–831, 2018.
(with Haoran Fu and Takashi Akamatsu)
8. [Harris and Wilson \(1978\) model revisited: The spatial period-doubling bifurcation in an urban retail model](#), *Journal of Regional Science*, 57(3), 442–466, 2017.
(with Takashi Akamatsu and Yuki Takayama)

Working Papers

1. [Understanding regional dynamics](#), 2025.
2. [Sampling logit equilibrium and endogenous payoff distortion](#), 2025.
3. [Innovation, spillovers and economic geography](#) with José Maria Gaspar. 2025.
4. [Most likely retail agglomeration patterns](#), with Takashi Akamatsu and Yosuke Kogure. 2025.
5. [Origin of power laws and their spatial fractal structure for city-size distributions](#), with Takashi Akamatsu, Tomoya Mori, and Yuki Takayama. 2024.
6. [Production externalities and dispersion process in a multi-region economy](#), with José Maria Gaspar. 2020.

Research Grants (PI Only)

1. **Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C)** (26K07706),
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (2026.04 – 2029.03). ¥4,550,000
2. **Grant-in-Aid for Scientific Research (C)** (22K04353),
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (2022.04 – 2026.03). ¥3,510,000
3. **Grant-in-Aid for Early-Career Scientists** (19K14735),
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (2019.04 – 2022.03). ¥4,290,000
4. **Grant-in-Aid for Young Scientists (B)** (17K14735),
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (2017.04 – 2019.03). ¥4,290,000
5. **Grant-in-Aid for JSPS Fellows** (14J02901)
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (2014.04 – 2016.09). ¥2,800,000

Honors and Fellowships

1. **JSPS Research Fellowship for Young Scientists (DC1)**,
Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (2014.04 – 2016.09).
2. 2017 米谷・佐佐木賞（学位論文部門）（Kometani–Sasaki Award for doctoral theses),
Institute of Systems Science Research.
3. 2016 土木学会論文奨励賞 (Doboku Gakkai Ronbun Shourei Shou),
Japan Society of Civil Engineers.
4. 2014 土木学会論文賞 (Doboku Gakkai Ronbun Shou),
Japan Society of Civil Engineers. (Joint with T. Akamatsu, T. Nagae, and H. Yamaguchi)

Professional Services

- **Referee:** Journal of Urban Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Journal of Regional Science, Spatial Economic Analysis, Journal of Royal Society: Interface, Economic Theory, International Journal of Game Theory, Journal of Public Economic Theory, Triennial Symposium on Transportation Analysis conference (TRISTAN), 土木学会論文集, 応用地域学研究
 - **Best Referee Award**, Spatial Economic Analysis, 2025
- **Discussion:** Urban Economics Association, Regional Science Association International, 応用地域学会

Personal

Born in 1990. Grew up in Matsumoto, Nagano. Citizenship: Japan.

(Last update: May 1, 2026)